

HOUSE No. 4552

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, September 29, 2025.

The committee on Financial Services, to whom was referred the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 1223) of Sally P. Kerans and Kristin E. Kassner relative to providing health insurance coverage for scalp and facial hair prosthesis, reports recommending that the accompanying bill (House, No. 4552) ought to pass.

For the committee,

JAMES M. MURPHY.

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The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to ensure access to scalp and facial hair prostheses for children and adults with alopecia areata.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Subsection (b) of section 17E of chapter 32A of the General Laws, as
2 appearing in the 2022 Official Edition, is hereby amended by inserting, in line 11, after the
3 words “cancer or leukemia;” the following:-

4 or as a result of alopecia areata, alopecia totalis, non-classical 21-hydroxylase or
5 permanent loss of facial or scalp hair due to injury; provided, however, that the alopecia is not
6 part of the natural or premature aging process; and

7 SECTION 2. Chapter 175 of the General Laws, as so appearing, is hereby amended by
8 inserting, before section 47CCC the following section:-

9 Section 47AAA. (a) As used in this section, the following words shall have the following
10 meanings:-

“Prosthesis”, an artificial appliance used to replace a lost natural structure; provided, however, that prosthesis shall include, but not be limited to, artificial arms, legs, breasts, scalp hair, facial pigmentation or glass eyes.

"Scalp hair prosthesis", an artificial substitute for scalp hair.

"Facial medical pigmentation", an artificial substitute for facial hair, including, but not limited to, eyebrows.

(b) An individual policy of accident and sickness insurance issued under section 108 that provides hospital expense and surgical expense insurance and any group blanket or general policy of accident and sickness insurance issued under section 110 that provides hospital expense and surgical expense insurance, which is issued or renewed within or without the commonwealth, shall provide benefits on a nondiscriminatory basis for any other prosthesis, coverage for expenses for facial medical pigmentation or scalp hair prostheses worn for hair loss suffered as a result of the treatment of any form of cancer or leukemia, or as a result of alopecia areata, alopecia totalis, non-classical 21-hydroxylase or permanent loss of facial or scalp hair due to injury; provided, however, that the alopecia is not part of the natural or premature aging process; and provided, however, that such coverage shall be subject to a written statement by the treating physician that the facial medical pigmentation or scalp hair prosthesis is medically necessary; and provided, further, that such coverage shall be subject to the same limitations and guidelines as other prostheses.

SECTION 3. Chapter 176A of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official Edition, is hereby amended by inserting after section 8DDD the following section:-

Section 8EEE. (a) As used in this section, the following words shall have the following meanings:-

“Prosthesis”, an artificial appliance used to replace a lost natural structure; provided, however, that prosthesis shall include, but not be limited to, artificial arms, legs, breasts, scalp hair, facial pigmentation or glass eyes.

“Scalp hair prosthesis”, an artificial substitute for scalp hair.

"Facial medical pigmentation", an artificial substitute for facial hair, including, but not limited to, eyebrows.

A contract between a subscriber and the corporation under an individual or group hospital service plan that is issued or renewed within or without the commonwealth shall provide benefits on a nondiscriminatory basis for expenses for facial medical pigmentation or scalp hair prosthesis worn for hair loss suffered as a result of the treatment of any form of cancer or leukemia, or as a result of alopecia areata, alopecia totalis, non-classical 21-hydroxylase or permanent loss of scalp hair due to injury; provided, however, that the alopecia is not part of the natural or premature aging process; and provided, however, that such coverage shall be subject to a written statement by the treating physician that the facial medical pigmentation or scalp hair prosthesis is medically necessary. Such coverage shall be subject to the same limitations and guidelines as other prosthesis. Such pigmentation and prosthesis coverage shall be provided at a minimum at the same amount and frequency as any state insurer provides for hair prostheses for hair loss due to chemotherapy.

SECTION 4. Chapter 176B of the General Laws, as so appearing, is hereby amended by inserting after section 4DDD the following section:-

Section 4EEE. (a) As used in this section, the following words shall have the following meanings:-

“Prosthesis”, an artificial appliance used to replace a lost natural structure; provided, however, that prosthesis shall include, but not be limited to, artificial arms, legs, breasts, scalp hair, facial pigmentation or glass eyes.

“Scalp hair prosthesis”, an artificial substitute for scalp hair.

"Facial medical pigmentation", an artificial substitute for facial hair, including, but not limited to, eyebrows.

A subscription certificate under an individual or group medical service agreement that is issued or renewed within or without the commonwealth shall provide benefits on a nondiscriminatory basis for expenses for facial medical pigmentation or scalp hair prosthesis worn for hair loss suffered as a result of the treatment of any form of cancer or leukemia, or as a result of alopecia areata, alopecia totalis, non-classical 21-hydroxylase, or permanent loss of facial or scalp hair due to injury; provided, however, that the alopecia is not part of the natural or premature aging process. Such coverage, however, shall be subject to a written statement by the treating physician that the medical pigmentation or hair prosthesis is medically necessary. Such coverage shall be subject to the same limitations and guidelines as other prosthesis. Such medical pigmentation or scalp hair prosthesis coverage shall be provided at a minimum at the same amount and frequency as any state insurer provides for hair prostheses for hair loss due to chemotherapy.

SECTION 5. Chapter 176G of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official Edition, is hereby amended by inserting after section 4VV the following section:-

Section 4WW. (a) As used in this section, the following words shall have the following meanings:-

“Prosthesis”, an artificial appliance used to replace a lost natural structure; provided, however, that prosthesis shall include, but not be limited to, artificial arms, legs, breasts, scalp hair, facial pigmentation or glass eyes.

“Scalp hair prosthesis”, an artificial substitute for scalp hair.

"Facial medical pigmentation", an artificial substitute for facial hair, including, but not limited to, eyebrows.

A health maintenance contract issued or renewed within or without the commonwealth shall provide benefits on a nondiscriminatory basis for facial hair loss suffered as a result of the treatment of any form of cancer or leukemia, or as a result of alopecia areata, alopecia totalis, non-classical 21-hydroxylase or permanent loss of facial or scalp hair due to injury; provided, however, that the alopecia is not part of the natural or premature aging process; and provided, however, that such coverage shall be subject to a written statement by the treating physician that the facial medical pigmentation or scalp hair prosthesis is medically necessary. Such coverage shall be subject to the same limitations and guidelines as other prostheses. Such prosthesis coverage shall be provided at a minimum at the same amount and frequency as any state insurer provides for hair prostheses for hair loss due to chemotherapy.